

Aaron Grusi

Professional Summary

Positive, optimistic, and action-oriented Customer Success leader with 10+ years of SaaS experience, a natural relationship builder with a consistent record of client retention and account growth. Proven track record managing enterprise portfolios, driving adoption and expansion across complex accounts, and leading teams with a people-first approach. Builder and innovator, comfortable operating without a playbook. Background spans frontline CSM work, people management, CS and revenue operations, L&D program design, and large-scale contact center leadership. I bring a combination of relationship depth, operational systems thinking, and the ability to translate data into action at every level of an organization.

Career Portfolio Highlights

Logo Renewal Rate	NRR	Expansion Rate	Largest Individual Client
95%	108%+	15%	\$3mil ARR

Core Competencies

- Enterprise portfolio ownership, onboarding through renewal
 - High EQ communicator across technical and business audiences
 - Player - Coach: team leadership alongside direct account ownership
 - Executive QBRs, C-suite relationships, and stakeholder alignment
 - Strong CRM & CSM platform fluency with previous administration experience including Salesforce
 - Retention, expansion, and upsell / cross-selling motions
 - Cross-functional collaboration: CS, Sales, Marketing, and Product teams
 - Data-driven decision making and executive storytelling
 - Onboarding, adoption, and time-to-value program design and implementation
 - Health scoring, risk mitigation, and renewal forecasting
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Experience

CBT Nuggets | Oregon

Senior Customer Success Manager / CS Operations Manager | July 2015 – October 2025

- Managed a diverse \$5mil ARR portfolio of up to 200 accounts with a strong mix of enterprise and government organizations, including DoD and defense contractors. Consistently produced top results in the team of 95% logo renewal and over 108% NRR through targeted engagements, thoughtful QBRs, and a strong focus on rapid time to value.
- Served as a player-coach, leading and developing the CS team while maintaining direct ownership of critical accounts, building the relationship depth that resulted in long-term retention and expansion. Portfolio performance was tops on the team, demonstrating a strong ability to lead by example and handle the most complex and valuable clients.
- Created a fully automated digital CS experience for SMB segment, allowing our CS team to focus efforts on higher value accounts, while still ensuring a human touch at critical junctions when intervention was needed.

- Designed and managed 200+ customer lifecycle email journeys spanning onboarding, engagement, upsell, and renewal, achieving 30–40% open rates and 6–10% CTR, 2–4x industry benchmarks.
- Redesigned underperforming upsell and payment workflows, launching targeted programs that tripled mid-cycle upsell revenue and drove on-time payment rates from ~70% to 98%.
- Implemented AI-automation in processes where best applicable, such as in health score calculations, risk assessment, and sentiment gathering.
- Administered Salesforce, Totango, Hightouch, and SendGrid across CS, Sales, and Support, managing data syncs between Tinybird SQL datasets and GTM platforms.
- Built the CS operations function from the ground up including journey mapping, health scoring models, lifecycle playbooks, and intervention frameworks, creating a scalable, data-driven foundation that directly enabled the CS team to operate more effectively across all segments.
- Collaborated with marketing, sales, and product teams to ensure that customer feedback and barriers resulted in improved product iterations and reduced friction.

FCR | Oregon

Senior Client Relations Manager & Site Director | *April 2013 – June 2015*

- Took over an under-performing site and scaled headcount from 140 to 330+ in one year, driving 3x client portfolio growth from \$6mil ARR to well over \$20mil ARR.
- Landed FCR's largest new client in over four years, leveraging wireless and contact center expertise to redesign their call workflows, update CRM and agent tools, and overhaul call evaluation standards, resulting in an 8% CSAT improvement.
- Conducted executive QBRs with all major clients including COO-level engagement; visited Bay area clients bi-monthly to maintain high-touch strategic relationships.

SKILLS & TOOLS

- Customer Success: Enterprise portfolio management, lifecycle ownership, NPS / CSAT, health scoring, player - coach role comfort, onboarding, adoption, 1:1 coaching, QBRs, retention and expansion, renewal forecasting, target ownership, excellent presentation, negotiation, and communication skills
- Operations & RevOps: CS ops program design, playbook development, journey mapping, Salesforce admin, Totango admin, Hightouch, Tinybird, SendGrid, Asana, Jira, Google Workspace, Microsoft Tools
- Analytics: SQL, Tableau, KPI dashboards, data visualization, executive reporting, campaign performance tracking
- Leadership & L&D: People management, people & team development, leadership training program design, hiring, performance management, coaching, feedback, situational leadership, problem solver
- AI Tools: Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini. Applied to CSM workflows, SQL development, and data analysis.